

# ALDI Nord — om-connector Production-Discovery

Use this for a focused **90-minute architecture-clarification meeting** with the ALDI Nord platform / data governance team. Six must-know clusters. Per cluster: short rationale, the questions, fields to write the answers into, the default we would ship if no answer comes, and what the answer concretely changes on Solace's side.

*Anything else (operations / observability / SLOs / multi-environment / cross-system lineage / distribution & licensing) is on the follow-up list and can be parked for a Block-2 / Block-3 meeting.*

## Meeting context

|                     |                                                                                                        |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Date                | _____                                                                                                  |
| Solace attendees    | _____                                                                                                  |
| ALDI Nord attendees | _____                                                                                                  |
| Goal                | Lock the data model + identity + security envelope for v1.0 of the Solace EP → OpenMetadata connector. |
| Out of scope today  | Rollout plan, operations runbook, lineage to non-Solace systems, distribution model.                   |
| Pre-read for ALDI   | One-page demo recap (see <code>docs/workshop-demo-script.md</code> )                                   |

## Cluster 1 — EP edition & API capabilities

**Why this matters first:** every other answer depends on what your EP edition exposes. Cloud v2 (our pilot tenant) does not ship Modeled-Mesh, Audit-Feed or Webhook-Subscription endpoints; an on-prem / Insights edition might.

### Questions

| Q                                                                          | Answer                                                                                                    | Source          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 1.1 EP edition & release                                                   | <i>Cloud Enterprise / Insights / Self-Managed</i> , version _____                                         | ALDI            |
| 1.2 Region(s) / number of EP tenants                                       | _ <b>tenants in</b> ____ regions                                                                          | ALDI            |
| 1.3 <code>/architecture/modeledEventMeshes</code> available?               | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> unknown — test together | Solace verifies |
| 1.4 <code>/architecture/auditEvents</code> (architecture-level) available? | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> unknown                 | Solace verifies |
| 1.5 Webhook-Subscription CRUD available?                                   | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> unknown                 | Solace verifies |
| 1.6 Are EP <b>Custom Attributes</b> used? On which entity types?           | Domain ____ Event ____ App ____<br>Schema ____                                                            | ALDI            |

| Q                                                             | Answer                                                                                    | Source          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 1.7 Do you use <b>Event API + Event API Product</b> concepts? | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> planned | ALDI            |
| 1.8 Webhook <i>signing</i> — HMAC header name?                | _____ (e.g. Solace-Signature )                                                            | Solace verifies |

### What this changes on the Solace side

- 1.3 yes → re-enable `emitDataProducts=true` and ship a Modeled-Mesh → OM-DataProduct mapping.
- 1.4 yes → drop the watermark-based reconcile fallback, switch to audit-replay (faster, deletes-aware).
- 1.5 yes → enable `BRIDGE_MODE=http` for sub-second latency, ship a one-shot `--register-webhook` per environment.
- 1.7 yes → add `Container` (Event-API) + `DataProduct` (Event-API-Product) mappings, cross-link to underlying events.

### Default if no answer

Cloud v2 endpoints only, audit-replay disabled, `BRIDGE_MODE=polling` , no Event-API mapping.

## Cluster 2 — OM edition, version & feature-set

**Why:** OM 1.6 ships Data Products, OM ≥ 1.5 ships Sub-Domains, and the Glossary feature changes the mapping target for EP tags.

### Questions

| Q                                                                            | Answer                                                                                                | Source |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 2.1 OM edition (Collate Cloud / Self-Hosted) + version                       | _____                                                                                                 | ALDI   |
| 2.2 Domains feature enabled? Sub-Domains hierarchy used?                     | <input type="checkbox"/> flat <input type="checkbox"/> hierarchical <input type="checkbox"/> not used | ALDI   |
| 2.3 Glossary in use? Term-IDs we should map to?                              | <input type="checkbox"/> yes — terms: _____ <input type="checkbox"/> no                               | ALDI   |
| 2.4 Tags / Classifications already in use? Which?                            | _____                                                                                                 | ALDI   |
| 2.5 Other OM connectors live (Kafka, Snowflake, dbt, Spark, ...)             | _____                                                                                                 | ALDI   |
| 2.6 Who operates OM? Solace-managed / ALDI-platform / vendor?                | _____                                                                                                 | ALDI   |
| 2.7 Latest OM upgrade cadence (we need to keep up with breaking SDK changes) | _____                                                                                                 | ALDI   |

### What this changes

- 2.2 hierarchical → connector emits sub-domains for nested EP-domain structures (if EP supports it).
- 2.3 yes → EP tags → Glossary-Terms instead of plain Classification-Tags.
- 2.5 cross-connectors → opens the door to **cross-system lineage** (Block 3 topic).
- 2.7 → defines our minimum OM-version compatibility matrix.

## Default

OM 1.6.5 Self-Hosted, flat Domains, no Glossary, only the Solace connector active.

## Cluster 3 — Asset-mapping completeness

**Why:** this is the heart of "10/10". The Kafka connector maps Topics + Schemas + Lineage. We want to match or exceed that for EP.

### Current mapping (what the pilot delivers today)

| EP entity            | OM entity                                      | Today |
|----------------------|------------------------------------------------|-------|
| Application Domain   | OM Domain                                      | ✓     |
| Application Version  | OM Pipeline (under synthetic PipelineService)  | ✓     |
| Event Version        | OM Topic                                       | ✓     |
| Schema Version       | embedded as<br>Topic.messageSchema             | ✓     |
| Pub/Sub declarations | OM Lineage edges Pipeline ↔ Topic              | ✓     |
| Lifecycle state      | Tag EventPortal.<State> + Custom Property      | ✓     |
| Topic address        | Custom Property<br>eventPortalTopicAddress     | ✓     |
| Back-links to EP UI  | Markdown Custom Properties on Topic + Pipeline | ✓     |

### Gap questions

| Q                                                                                                                                                                    | Answer                                                                                                                      | Notes                                                   |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.1 Should <b>Schemas</b> be first-class OM entities (e.g. under a synthetic DatabaseService "Solace EP Schema Registry") with their own page, versions and lineage? | <input type="checkbox"/> keep embedded <input type="checkbox"/> promote to first-class <input type="checkbox"/> both        | Kafka connector promotes them; matches user expectation |
| 3.2 Should <b>Modeled Event Meshes</b> become OM <b>DataProducts</b> ? (depends on 1.3)                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> later                                     |                                                         |
| 3.3 Should <b>Event-API Products</b> become OM DataProducts? (depends on 1.7)                                                                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> later                                     |                                                         |
| 3.4 Topic-address hierarchy (acme/md/customer/*) → OM Container folder structure?                                                                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> flat <input type="checkbox"/> folder-by-segment <input type="checkbox"/> folder-by-business-domain |                                                         |
| 3.5 Should every <b>Topic version</b> be a separate OM entity (history), or only the <b>latest</b> ?                                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> latest only <input type="checkbox"/> all versions <input type="checkbox"/> last N                  | Today: latest only                                      |

| Q                                                                                                                                                          | Answer                                                                                                         | Notes                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 3.6 EP <b>Custom Attributes</b> → which OM target: Custom Properties, Tags or Glossary?                                                                    | per attribute decision:<br>_____                                                                               | Depends on 1.6                                                   |
| 3.7 EP <b>Categories</b> (if any) → OM Tags or Glossary?                                                                                                   | <input type="checkbox"/> tags <input type="checkbox"/> glossary <input type="checkbox"/> custom property       |                                                                  |
| 3.8 Should <b>Consumer Subscriptions</b> (subscribers per topic) become separate OM lineage edges or just stay in <code>declaredConsumed...Ids</code> ?    | <input type="checkbox"/> separate entities <input type="checkbox"/> lineage only <input type="checkbox"/> none |                                                                  |
| 3.9 <b>Description aggregation</b> : EP has descriptions on Domain, Event, EventVersion, Schema, App, AppVersion. Which is the primary, which is appended? | _____                                                                                                          | Today: Event description + EventVersion description concatenated |
| 3.10 <b>AsyncAPI export</b> per Application Version — should we attach it as a downloadable artifact to the Pipeline?                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no                                                       | OM supports <code>sourceUrl</code> field                         |

### What this changes

- 3.1 promote → adds a new `CustomDatabase` -style service `solace-event-portal-schemas` , schema-per-entity with versions, links from Topics.
- 3.4 hierarchy → uses OM's `Container` entity for the topic-address folder tree, queryable + breadcrumb-navigable.
- 3.5 all versions → already supported via `ingestAllVersions=true` ; just a config flip.

### Default

Schemas stay embedded, latest version only, flat topic addresses, no AsyncAPI artifact.

## Cluster 4 — Identity, ownership & teams

**Why:** today we set `resolveOwners=false` because EP returns user-IDs (e.g. `udz8x00uz2o` ), not e-mails. For ALDI's RBAC and self-service "who do I bug about this topic", this needs to be solved.

### Questions

| Q                                                                                                 | Answer                                                                                                                                          | Source          |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 4.1 Are EP users + OM users the same identity (same Keycloak login)?                              | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> mostly <input type="checkbox"/> no                                                        | ALDI            |
| 4.2 Which Keycloak claim joins them?                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> email <input type="checkbox"/> preferred_username <input type="checkbox"/> sub<br><input type="checkbox"/> other: ____ | ALDI            |
| 4.3 Does your EP edition expose user lookup ( <code>/iam/users/{id}</code> or similar)?           | <input type="checkbox"/> yes — path: ____ <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> unknown                                          | Solace verifies |
| 4.4 Failing 4.3: are you OK with a <b>static User-ID</b> → <b>E-Mail map</b> in connector config? | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no, please find another way                                                               | ALDI            |

| Q                                                                                        | Answer                                                                                                    | Source |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|
| 4.5 Should <b>multiple Owners</b> be supported (Domain-Owner + App-Owner + Topic-Owner)? | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> just one <input type="checkbox"/> only Domain-Owner | ALDI   |
| 4.6 EP Team concept — should it map to <b>OM Teams</b> ?                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> yes — list of EP-teams: ____ <input type="checkbox"/> no                         | ALDI   |
| 4.7 Connector service-account in EP — who creates / rotates? Rotation cadence?           | _____ days, rotated by _____                                                                              | ALDI   |
| 4.8 OM ingestion-bot JWT — same question.                                                | _____                                                                                                     | ALDI   |

### What this changes

- 4.3 yes → connector resolves user-IDs at runtime, no manual map needed, `resolveOwners=true` becomes default.
- 4.4 yes → ship `userIdToEmailMap` connection option (JSON map), document the maintenance path.
- 4.6 yes → emit OM-Team links instead of (or in addition to) user-Owners.

### Default

Manual `userIdToEmailMap` JSON in connection options, Domain-Owner only, no Team mapping. (Brittle; expect this answer to evolve.)

## Cluster 5 — Bi-directionality & source of truth

**Why:** governs whether we ever write *into* EP. Wrong answer here creates silent drift between systems within months.

### Questions

| Q                                                                                                                              | Answer                                                                                                                                                     | Notes                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| 5.1 Is <b>EP the single source of truth</b> for event metadata?                                                                | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no, OM also enriches                                                                                 | One-way vs. bi-directional architecture                     |
| 5.2 If 5.1 = no: which fields are owned by OM and should write back to EP?                                                     | _____                                                                                                                                                      | e.g. extended description, business glossary, certification |
| 5.3 Conflict resolution if both sides change the same field:                                                                   | <input type="checkbox"/> EP wins <input type="checkbox"/> OM wins <input type="checkbox"/> last-writer <input type="checkbox"/> manual flag                |                                                             |
| 5.4 Delete handling: event removed in EP — what happens to the OM Topic?                                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> soft-delete <input type="checkbox"/> hard-delete <input type="checkbox"/> keep with "Retired" tag <input type="checkbox"/> manual | Today: keep (no auto-delete)                                |
| 5.5 Tag handling: tag added in OM (not present in EP) — does next ingest remove it?                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> preserve <input type="checkbox"/> overwrite from EP <input type="checkbox"/> mark as "OM-added"                                   | Today: preserve (additive merge)                            |
| 5.6 OM <b>Certification</b> of a Topic (e.g. "Tier 1 production data") — should we push that back to EP as a custom attribute? | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> later                                                                    |                                                             |

## What this changes

- 5.1 no → ship a **reverse-write component** in the bridge (POST/PUT to EP architecture endpoints), with conflict policy from 5.3.
- 5.4 hard-delete → connector watches EP audit/list-diff, soft-deletes OM topics that disappeared.
- 5.6 yes → certification webhook in OM → POST to EP custom-attribute endpoint.

## Default

EP is sole source of truth, OM additive only, no auto-deletes, no write-back. (Safest; expect 5.6 to become "yes" within 12 months as trust grows.)

## Cluster 6 — Security & compliance

**Why:** ALDI is EU retail. GDPR + audit + secrets are blockers, not nice-to-haves. Today we have placeholders only.

### Questions

| Q                                                                                                    | Answer                                                                                                                                                           | Notes                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| 6.1 GDPR classification of EP entities — does any topic name / sample payload contain personal data? | _____                                                                                                                                                            | If yes: needs separate review per domain |
| 6.2 Sample-data (live broker messages) — allowed at all? Per-domain decision?                        | <input type="checkbox"/> never <input type="checkbox"/> allow-list-only <input type="checkbox"/> free-for-all                                                    | Today: disabled                          |
| 6.3 Sample-data retention in OM                                                                      | _____ days                                                                                                                                                       | If enabled at all                        |
| 6.4 Audit-log target for OM actions (who saw/changed what)                                           | <input type="checkbox"/> Splunk <input type="checkbox"/> DataDog <input type="checkbox"/> Loki <input type="checkbox"/> not required                             |                                          |
| 6.5 mTLS required between Connector ↔ EP?                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> yes <input type="checkbox"/> no <input type="checkbox"/> only between Bridge ↔ OM                                                       |                                          |
| 6.6 Secrets-backend                                                                                  | <input type="checkbox"/> HashiCorp Vault <input type="checkbox"/> AWS-SSM <input type="checkbox"/> sealed-K8s-Secrets <input type="checkbox"/> plain K8s-Secrets | Today: plain K8s-Secrets                 |
| 6.7 EP API-Token rotation cadence + automation                                                       | every ____ days, automated via ____                                                                                                                              |                                          |
| 6.8 OM ingestion-bot JWT rotation cadence + automation                                               | every ____ days, automated via ____                                                                                                                              |                                          |
| 6.9 Network isolation — is the OM cluster in the same VPC as EP or external?                         | _____                                                                                                                                                            |                                          |
| 6.10 Data residency — where can OM-stored EP metadata physically live?                               | _____ region/country                                                                                                                                             |                                          |

## What this changes

- 6.1 PII present → introduces a `pii: true/false` Custom Property on Topic, blocks sample-data per default for those topics.
- 6.4 SIEM target set → ships an OM audit-exporter sidecar with the right format.

- 6.6 Vault → connector reads tokens via `secret:vault://path/to/key` notation, no plain-text in OM service config.
- 6.10 specific region → constrains where the OM cluster + ingestion containers may run.

## Default

No PII expectation, sample-data globally disabled, plain K8s-Secrets, no audit-export. (Block 1 for a Production-Pilot, but **not acceptable for a v1.0 GA release**.)

## Decision log (fill during the meeting)

| ID   | Topic | Decision | Owner | Due |
|------|-------|----------|-------|-----|
| D-01 |       |          |       |     |
| D-02 |       |          |       |     |
| D-03 |       |          |       |     |
| D-04 |       |          |       |     |
| D-05 |       |          |       |     |
| D-06 |       |          |       |     |
| D-07 |       |          |       |     |
| D-08 |       |          |       |     |
| D-09 |       |          |       |     |
| D-10 |       |          |       |     |

## Open follow-ups (Block 2 / Block 3 — schedule separately)

| Topic                                                               | Block | Trigger                                       |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Operations & observability (Prometheus, OTel, SLOs, DR)             | 2     | when Block-1 architecture is signed off       |
| Cross-system lineage (Solace ↔ Kafka ↔ Snowflake ↔ Databricks ↔ BI) | 3     | when other OM connectors are inventoried      |
| Distribution / licensing / upstream-PR to OpenMetadata              | 3     | when v1.0 scope is locked                     |
| Multi-environment (Dev / Stage / Prod) + CI/CD pipeline             | 2     | parallel to operations cluster                |
| Self-service onboarding UI for domain owners                        | 3     | when role boundaries from Cluster 4 are clear |

## What Solace commits to do after the meeting

---

Within **2 weeks** of receiving Block-1 answers:

- Updated **mapping spec** (Cluster 3) committed as `docs/asset-mapping-spec.md` .
- **Identity-resolution prototype** (Cluster 4) merged + tested against ALDI Keycloak.
- **Security baseline** (Cluster 6) implemented: Vault-backed secrets, audit-export sidecar stub.
- **EP-edition feature matrix** (Cluster 1) ratified with `scripts/smoke_ep_api.py` output as evidence.
- Bumped version to **v1.0.0-rc1**, deployed to ALDI's staging OM.

Within **6 weeks**:

- v1.0.0 GA release in `registry.solace.lab` + ghcr.io.
- ALDI pilot domain in production OM, Plattform-Team sign-off.
- Public design-doc for upstream-contribution discussion (if Block 3 says "yes").

---

*Last updated:* generated \_\_\_\_\_

*Document owner:* Solace, [mailto:\[your-email@solace.com\]](mailto:[your-email@solace.com])